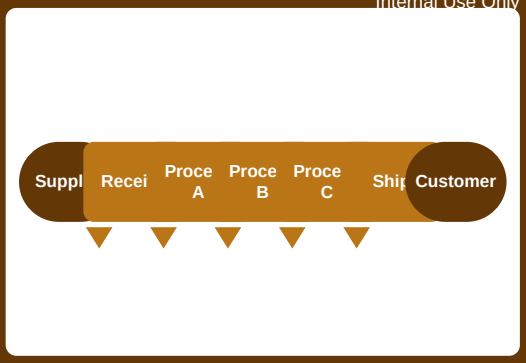
Internal Use Only

Value Stream Mapping

Visualise the entire flow of material and information from raw material to customer — revealing waste, delays, and



WHEN TO USE

Before any major process improvement initiative; whenever lead time is the primary constraint or complaint.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Select a specific product family or value stream to map
2. Walk the process end-to-end with a pencil and stopwatch — never map from memory
3. Record process metrics at each step: cycle time, lead time, inventory levels, uptime
4. Identify the largest sources of waste and delay
5. Design the future state map with specific improvements
6. Build a phased implementation roadmap to close the gap

PRACTITIONER TIP

! A VSM done at a desk using estimates is fiction. Walk the actual process with real data every single time.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Current state value stream map
- Future state value stream map
- Implementation roadmap
- Lead time and value-added ratio analysis

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Lead time reduction %; value-added ratio improvement; total WIP inventory reduction

TOOL CATEGORY

Operations